



IC Master – The International Communication Master Competition

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The International Communication Master Competition – IC Master 2025 officially open for registration

The 13th season of the IC Master 2025, organized by the Faculty of Communication & International Culture at the Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam has officially begun. This year's theme is **"Echo of Zero: Developing Marketing Strategies for Net-Zero Enterprises."**



Net-Zero Enterprises are businesses that balance greenhouse gas emissions with removal from the atmosphere.¹Theoretically, their net emissions from production

¹ University of Oxford (2024) What Is Net Zero?, Net Zero Climate, <https://netzeroclimate.org/what-is-net-zero-2/>.

and business activities are zero.² However, in reality, environmentalists expect Net-Zero businesses to not even discharge any emission at all, rather than relying on large-scale offset technologies or unverified emission removal technologies to meet long-term climate goals.³

Facing the challenge of promoting sustainable business values, the Faculty of Communication & International Culture at the Diplomatic Academy of Vietnam has partnered with pioneering Net-Zero enterprises, to seek innovative sustainable marketing communication initiatives and work towards a zero-emission environment.

Through this competition, contestants will become connectors who bring sustainable business solutions and application of the circular economy model closer to the community. Thereby, marketing and communication strategies reinforce the position of pioneering brands, driving awareness of emerging economic models, and shift consumer behavior toward a greener, cleaner Earth.

"05 Net-Zero Stages" that contestants need to overcome

Registration Round – "I Confirm" (August 2, 2025 – August 12, 2025)

Regulation: A team consists of 3 to 5 members. Participants need to fill out the online registration form.

Preliminary Round "I Conceive" (August 13, 2025 – August 18, 2025)

Regulation: Eligible teams will receive an exam prompt online and must submit their proposals by the deadline.

An Orientation and Exhibition Day by businesses will be held. These events will provide teams with additional information and answers for inquiries, helping them define their approach to the challenge.

The 8 best-performing teams from this round will be selected to the next round.

Semi-Final Round "I Connect" (August 25, 2025 – September 7, 2025)

Regulation: Teams will develop their preliminary proposals into comprehensive ones and present them to the Judging Panel.

² VnExpress (2024) 'Cảm nang Net Zero', Tin nhanh VnExpress, <https://vnexpress.net/net-zero-la-gi-4794647.html>

³ National Grid (2023) What is net zero? | National Grid Group, Nationalgrid, <https://shorturl.at/r45WV>, accessed 2 April 2025

Each team will refine their proposal with mentor guidance and participate in training sessions. Additionally, teams will have the opportunity to visit businesses and engage in discussions with industry experts.

The presentations will occur on-site (or hybrid for distant participants). All teams will present their projects to the Judging Panel. 4 teams will be advanced.

Implementation Round “I Contribute” (September 15, 2025 – November 15, 2025)

Regulation: Teams will collaborate with businesses to implement the comprehensive proposals from the previous round.

Participants will execute their proposals using various online and offline media channels to gather real results. During the Implementation Round, teams will be recognized as marketing communications interns within the enterprises and will receive internship benefits.

Final Round “I Change” (November 23, 2025)

Regulation: The top 4 teams will present their implementation results at the live final stage. The top 2 teams will then participate in a debate and crisis management round to determine the champion.

In addition, participants may receive the opportunity to become full-time employees at the participating businesses (offered by the companies).

Registration Round “I Confirm” is officially open

Registration Information:

Registration Link: <https://forms.gle/7LXXEM7KrFZRptx58>

Registration Period: **9:00 PM on August 2, 2025 – 11:59 PM on August 12, 2025.**

Preliminary Round Assignment will be sent to registered teams on August 13, 2025.

Registration Requirements:

- All students aged 18-22 currently studying at universities or colleges nationwide, with a passion for fields such as Marketing, Journalism, Culture, Public Relations, and general Communications.
- Participation is in teams. Each team consists of 3-5 members.
- Participants must not have reached the Implementation Round of IC Master in previous years.

- Members of the competition's organizing committee are not allowed to participate as contestants.

If you're ready to become a "green communicator," don't hesitate to register and bring your creative ideas to life!

For any questions about the competition, please contact:

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